

How to Unzip and Open a Lab Project in IntelliJ IDEA

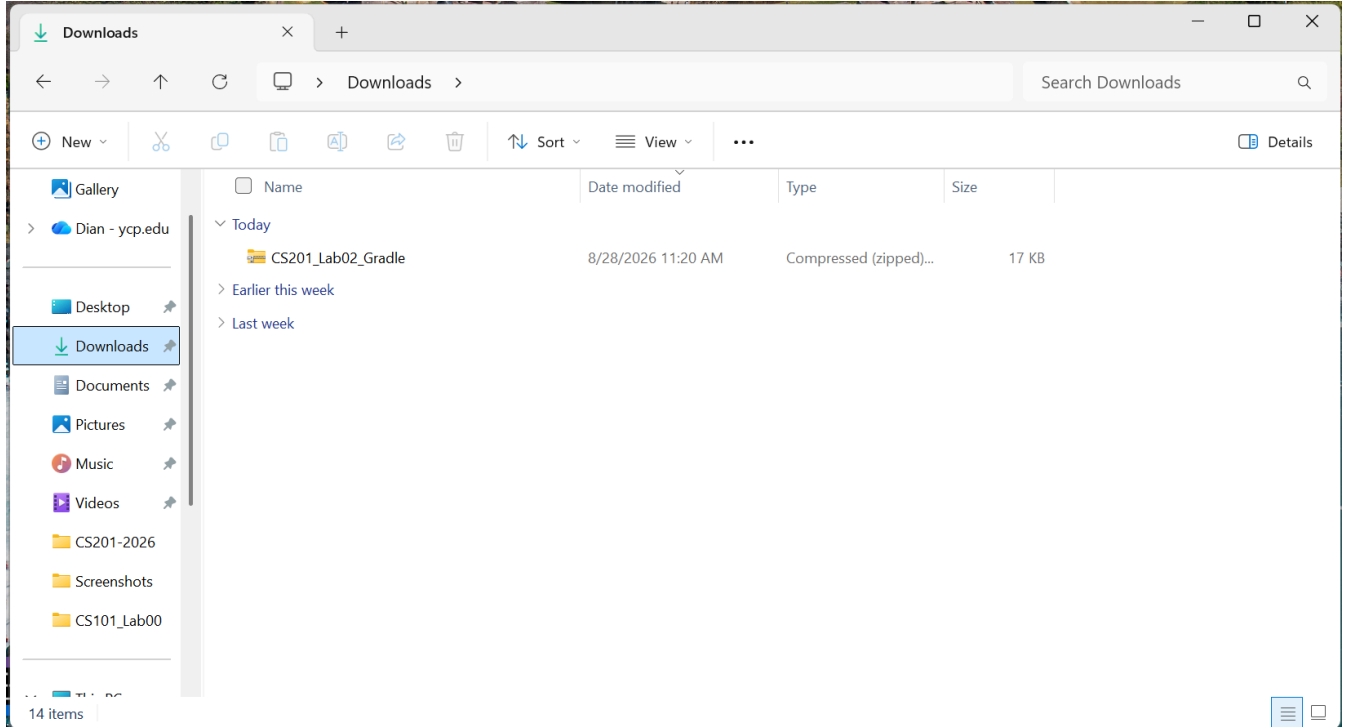
Follow these instructions after downloading the lab ZIP file from the course website.

Step 1: Download the ZIP File

1. Go to the course website and locate the lab assignment.
2. Download the ZIP file provided for the lab.
3. The file will usually be saved in your computer's **Downloads** folder unless you selected another location.

The downloaded file may have a name similar to:

CS201_Lab02_Gradle.zip

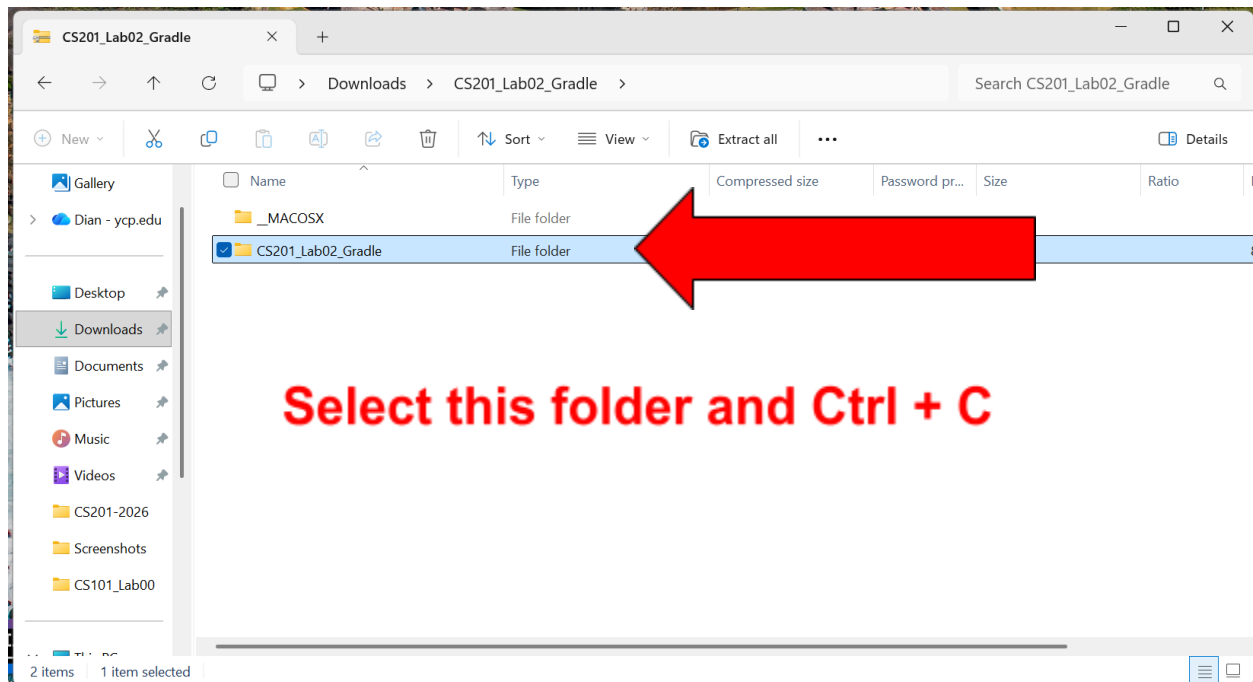


Step 2: Place the Lab Files in a Folder

You can use either of the following methods. The copy-and-paste method is recommended because it makes it easier to avoid accidentally creating duplicate nested folders.

Recommended method: Copy and paste the folder

1. Open your computer's **Downloads** folder.
2. Find the downloaded ZIP file.
3. Double-click the ZIP file to view its contents.
4. Inside the ZIP file, you should see a folder containing the lab project.
5. Select that folder.
6. Copy it by pressing **Ctrl+C** on Windows or **Command+C** on macOS.
7. Navigate to the location where you want to store the lab.



8. Paste the lab folder by pressing **Ctrl+V** on Windows or **Command+V** on macOS.
9. Wait for all the files to finish copying before opening the project in IntelliJ IDEA.

You may store the lab anywhere you like, but keeping all your labs inside a course folder will make them easier to find and manage.

Step 3: Identify the Correct Project Folder

Before opening IntelliJ IDEA, look inside the lab folder and confirm that you have reached the folder containing the actual project files.

For a Gradle project, the correct folder will usually contain items such as:

- `src`
- `build.gradle` or `build.gradle.kts`
- `settings.gradle` or `settings.gradle.kts`
- `gradlew`
- `gradlew.bat`
- A `gradle` folder

The exact files may vary, but the important point is that you should select the folder that directly contains these files.

For example, suppose your folders look like this:

`CS201-Lab02-Gradle` → `CS201-Lab02-Gradle` → `build.gradle`,
`src`, `gradlew`, and other files

In this case, the second—or inner—`CS201-Lab02-Gradle` folder is the correct folder to open.

Do not select the first, outer folder.

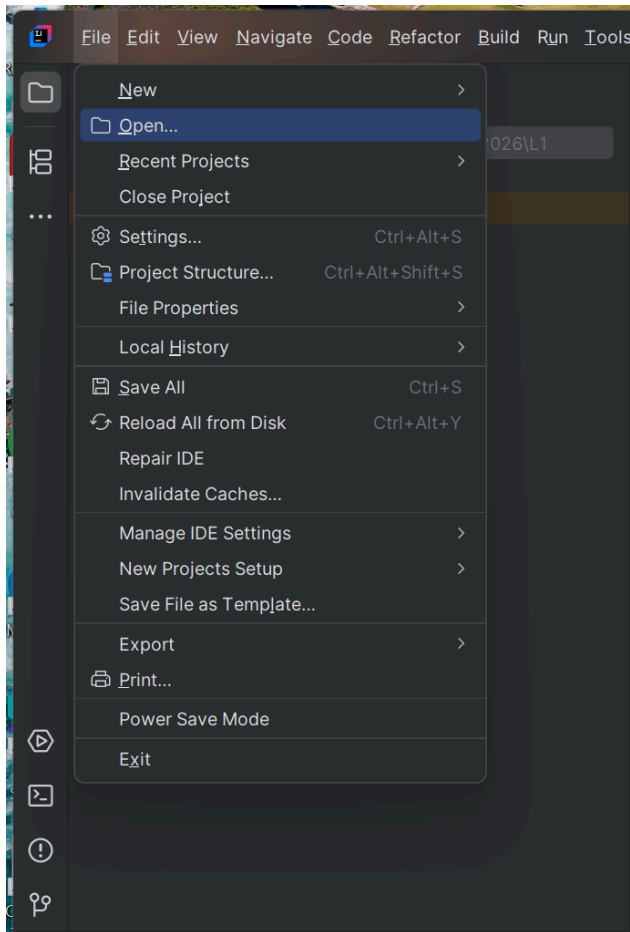
SEE NEXT PAGE (LAST STEP)

Step 4: Open the Project in IntelliJ IDEA

1. Start IntelliJ IDEA.
2. On the IntelliJ IDEA Welcome screen, click Open.

If another project is already open, you can instead select:

File → Open



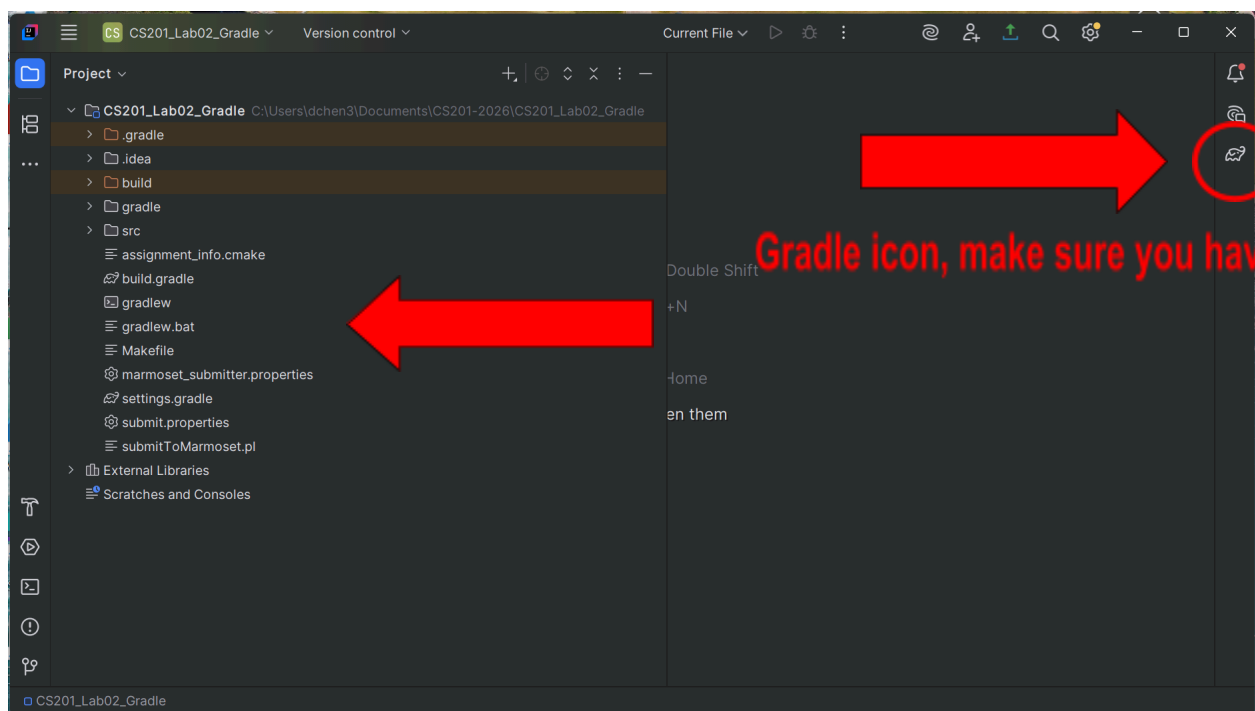
3. A folder-selection window will appear.
4. Navigate to the location where you saved the lab.
5. Open folders until you reach the final lab folder containing the actual project files.
6. Verify once more that you are selecting the folder containing files such as `build.gradle`, `settings.gradle`, and the `src` folder.
7. Select the correct folder.

8. Click Select Folder, Open, or OK, depending on your operating system and IntelliJ IDEA version.

If IntelliJ IDEA asks whether you trust the project, confirm that you trust it by selecting Trust Project.

If IntelliJ IDEA asks whether you want to open the project in the current window or a new window, either option is acceptable. Opening it in a new window may be more convenient if you want to keep another project open.

When the project is imported correctly, you should see the project files in the Project panel on the left side of the IntelliJ IDEA window. You should also see the Gradle tool-window icon—often displayed as an elephant—on the right side.



Important Reminder

Always open the last folder in the folder structure—the folder that directly contains the lab's files.

Incorrect:

CS201-Lab02-Gradle → CS201-Lab02-Gradle → project files

Opening the first CS201-Lab02-Gradle folder may cause IntelliJ IDEA to import the project incorrectly.

Correct:

Open the second CS201-Lab02-Gradle folder because it directly contains the project files.

Using the copy-and-paste method from inside the ZIP file can help prevent this duplicate-folder problem. Regardless of which extraction method you use, always confirm that the folder selected in IntelliJ IDEA directly contains the project's Gradle files and src folder.